

LucasArts shuts down

Developers of The Secret of Monkey Island close. Star Wars 1313 destined to be stuck in limbo <http://dgit.in/16rzQXj>



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Is the internet making us dumber? This infographic tells us why, and offers some possible solutions <http://dgit.in/12yfVt3>

but they are your normal modes such as Standard, Theatre, game, Scenery, Night view and sRGB. It not only allows colour temperature adjustment but there is even a skin tone adjustment option which can make the skin appear reddish, natural or yellowish.

Build Quality

In terms of pure build quality though, the NEC E231W leaves the rest of the competition far behind. It is the heaviest monitor of the lot though. The dedicated hollow space on the top rear side to easily lift the monitor is a thoughtful addition. The other monitor which we felt had a good build quality was the Dell S2240L with its sturdy stand and the ability to remain relatively stable on mild tapping. The only annoying aspect of the Dell S2240L is the recessed display ports on the rear side, which make it a task attaching the D-Sub or HDMI ports. The stand on the Philips 227E3QPHSU has a very slim design as compared to other monitors and it has a comparatively stiffer tilt mechanism. The disadvantage of the slimmer stand is that it tends to wobble a lot on mid tapping.

The display-menu control buttons on the NEC E231W are the best of the lot and you also have a joystick like four-way navigational key to toggle horizontally and vertically in the OSD menu. The ones on the ASUS VS238H require a comparatively harder press than those on the Dell S2240L and BenQ

GW 2250. Philips 227E3QPHSU was the only monitor with touch-screen menu control buttons. The operation is quite subjective, we for instance didn't like it much, but others may like it.

Performance

Starting off with the contrast ratios we measured using the Spyder 3 Elite colorimeter, the BenQ GW 2250 thanks to its VA panel scored the highest. It gave a contrast ratio of 888:1 at 50 per cent brightness levels. The Philips 227E3QPHSU came in second with a great contrast ratio of 759:1.



BenQ GW 2250

In the Lagom.nl tests, the Black levels on most of the monitors were good enough, but when it came to the White levels, we weren't so impressed with the Philips monitor which tended to merge two rows of blocks. In the gradient banding test, Dell S2240L gave smooth transitions but we noticed green colour tinting. ASUS VS238H was the smoothest transition from black to white. The NEC E231W did not flicker in any of the Pixel walk tests, which was quite impressive. Movie watching experience was the best on the BenQ GW 2250. We noticed that the movie preset modes, tended to boost up the blue colour levels and you

are much better off watching movies in the standard mode after proper calibration.

24-INCHES Features

The BenQ RL 2455HM looks similar to the XL 2720T and for a while we assumed it to be from the XL series. The design philosophy of using red accents, the triangular shaped front portion of the base stand pay homage to the XL series monitors. It has two HDMI ports, so you can also connect your console to the monitor if you so desire, which leaves the other HDMI port free. BenQ XL2411T is the only 3D gaming monitor with a refresh rate of 120Hz in this category. The BenQ GL 2450 is a regular monitor with nothing out of the ordinary so to speak.

The operational menus of both the RL2455HM and the XL2411T are quite similar. There is a Black Equaliser setting which allows you to adjust black levels in games such that darker portions are illuminated without completely washing out the brighter parts in the scene. You can have upto three Gamer profiles, so you do not need to adjust your controls for different games. There are two RTS presets in the RL2455HM and two FPS and one RTS preset in the XL2411T. The Display mode option allows you to select a variety of display sizes and aspect ratios.

The Acer S240HL has a slimmer profile as compared to the other monitors in this category. It has a small oval base and there is a translucent power button which protrudes out from the front face. In terms of the OSD options, there isn't much to speak of other than the Acer colour management mode which has modes such as standard, movie, graphics,

eco and user. Even in terms of colour management there is just the warm, cool and user presets.

The NEC EA243WM is the only monitor with a resolution of 1920x1200 in this category with an aspect ratio of 16:10. It has a slimmer profile than the E231W and houses touch-sensitive buttons for operating the OSD menu which go along the horizontal and vertical bottom right hand corners. Just like the E231W, it has two Eco modes, three auto-brightness levels as well as auto-contrast option. Apart from the ambient light sensor, it also has a human sensor which tends to dim the monitor when there is no one at the desk. You can set the distance between the monitor and the user beyond which the monitor should start dimming to save power. Additionally the NEC EA243WM also has the carbon footprint meter and the carbon savings meter. These features make a lot of sense in an office environment, where power saving is important.

Build Quality

The NEC EA243WM has the best build quality, closely followed by the RL2455HM and XL2411T. The NEC monitor has a solid base with rubber feet atop which lies another base which is connected to the stand. While swivelling, the entire base also follows suit. We really missed the buttons on the OSD menu though – the touch sensitive buttons are not the best to use when you have so many menus to toggle through. But quality of bezel, ability to resist wobbling on mild tapping is very good on the EA243WM. The RL2455HM has a sturdy base and stand, but the monitor tends to wobble on mild tapping. The XL2411T is much more stable than the RL2455HM thanks to